Charlen Baloukjy

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SUMMARY

Security+ certified Computer Science graduate ranked in the top 2% globally on TryHackMe, with 200+ hands-on labs and CTFs. I combine offensive skills (web exploitation, enumeration, Burp Suite, Nmap) with defensive skills (SIEM log analysis in Splunk and Elastic, Wireshark traffic analysis) to understand how attacks work and how to catch them. Built an Active Directory home lab and led a 5-person team through a full-stack capstone project. Seeking entry-level SOC analyst or junior penetration tester roles.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computer Science, Kutztown University of Pennsylvania *May 2026*
GPA: 3.4 | Cybersecurity Certificate | Languages: English (fluent), Arabic (fluent), German (intermediate)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Offensive Security: Vulnerability Assessment, Penetration Testing, Web Application Security, Nmap, Burp Suite, Metasploit, SQLMap, Hydra, Gobuster
Network & Defense: Wireshark, Splunk & ELK Stack (SIEM), TCP/IP, Ports & Protocols, Firewalls, Active Directory, Microsoft 365
Frameworks: OWASP Top 10, OWASP Top 10 for LLMs, MITRE ATT&CK, MITRE ATLAS
Programming & Scripting: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, C, C++, Bash, SQL, PowerShell

PROJECTS

Offensive & Defensive Security Labs & CTFs | TryHackMe (Top 2% globally) *Oct. 2025 – Present*

- Completed 200+ labs and CTFs and earned a top 2% global ranking, practicing enumeration, privilege escalation, web exploitation, and incident investigation
- Exploited SQL injection with SQLMap and Burp Suite, brute-forced web and SSH logins with Hydra, and enumerated directories, subdomains, and virtual hosts with Gobuster
- Investigated simulated incidents in Splunk (SPL) and the Elastic Stack (KQL), building searches, visualizations, and dashboards to detect anomalous VPN logins and identify indicators of compromise (IOCs)
- Analyzed network traffic in Wireshark to detect Nmap scans, ARP poisoning, DNS/ICMP tunneling, and cleartext credentials
- Mapped attacker behavior to MITRE ATT&CK techniques, and LLM attacks to OWASP Top 10 for LLMs and MITRE ATLAS
- Published 3 CTF write-ups documenting methodology and findings: github.com/CharlenB/TryHackMe-Writeups

EcoSmart: Smart Environmental Monitoring System | Kutztown University *Aug. 2025 – May 2026*

- Led a 5-person team to design and deliver a full-stack air quality monitoring system tracking temperature, humidity, CO2, CO, CH2O, TVOC, and natural gas
- Integrated hardware sensors with a React/TypeScript frontend, Supabase backend, and Vercel deployment
- Directed task assignment, testing, and system design across frontend, backend, and hardware workstreams

Active Directory Home Lab | VMware

- Built a Windows Server and Windows client environment in VMware to practice Active Directory administration
- Created and applied Group Policy Objects (GPOs), reset user passwords, and reviewed event logs

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ (Oct. 2026)
TryHackMe: Jr Penetration Tester (Jan. 2026), Web Application Pentesting (Mar. 2026), AI Security (Oct. 2026)
Kutztown University: Cybersecurity Certificate (May 2026)